Shaun O'Connell

Aspiring field guide, birder, nature photographer, and seasoned web developer

While I have almost 27 years of experience as a Web Developer, I'm gradually shifting my career towards more conservation-centric roles. I'm a qualified NQF2 Field Guide, currently working towards my NQF4.

Working experience

Today

Field Guide student at EcoTraining (Pty) Ltd.
August, 2026 to present day

I'm currently training for the Professional Field Guide (FGASA) qualification through EcoTraining, this includes:

- NQF2 ceritifcation (FGASA) - *Completed with a 89% result*
- Wilderness First Aid (Level 2) - *Completed*
- Basic Birding (EcoTraining) - *Completed*
- Trails Guide (FGASA)
- Advanced Rifle Handling (FGASA)
- Advanced Birding (EcoTraining)

2026

Freelance Front-end Web Developer at various South African organisations
August, 2024 to present day

After returning to South Africa, I worked primarily as a web developer, but I also used my spare time to improve my photography and birding skills. Some of the projects I worked on included Birds of Zevenwacht, and SASTI at Stellenbosch University.

2021

Freelance Front-end Web Developer at various New Zealand organisations
February, 2021 to July, 2024

Upon returning to New Zealand after COVID, I primarily worked as a freelance web developer. Some of my clients and employers included Te Whatu Ora, Health NZ, Ackama, Adminis, and Lil Regie

2020

Volunteer Web Development Teacher at Onja Madagascar
December, 2019 to October, 2020

During 2020, I worked in Madagascar, as a volunteer teacher for 20 aspiring web development students. Feel free to read more about this adventure on my blog.

2019

Senior Front-end Developer & Interaction Designer at various New Zealand organisations
October, 2014 to December, 2019

In October 2014, I moved to New Zealand for work.
I worked with several organisations over the 5 years including Abletech and AddressFinder, Homes.co.nz, Tangram at Trade Me and Flick Electric co.

2014

Front-end Developer & Interaction Designer at various South African organisations
January, 1999 to August, 2014

I then worked in South Africa for several organisations over 15 years, including: Dimension Data, Consology, CareerJunction, Kalahari.com, Yola, 22seven

Skills

General skills

- Nature photography
- Bird surveying and identification
- Birding tours / guiding

Tech-specific skills

- Web development, design systems development
- Storyboarding, prototyping, and interaction design
- Usability research
- General IT, networking, etc.

Interests

Birding & Wildlife	Birding has been an interest for the last 40 years, but it wasn't until 2024 that I started prioritising my learning. Take a look at my iNaturalist profiles. I'm also a contributor to SABAP2.
Volunteering	I've worked at The Two Oceans Aquarium, both front of house and behind the scenes. I've surveyed Blue Cranes through the Eastern Cape as part of EWT's Cranes Research Project. I'm a citizen scientist through SABAP2 and iNaturalist
Photography	I'm particularly interested in bird, wildlife, landscape, macro, and astro photography. I like to take photos of birds as an identification and surveying tool.

Get in touch

- Visit my site: tactile.co.za
- Email me: shaun@tactile.co.za
- LinkedIn: ndorfin
- GitHub: ndorfin

The latest version of this CV is available online at ndorfin.github.io/cv